

NORTHBRIDGE DYNAMICS PVT. LTD.

Grievance Redressal and Disciplinary Procedure

Document detail	Information
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Policy owner	Employee Relations
Approved by	Chief People Officer
Applies to	All permanent employees (confirmed and on probation) of Northbridge Dynamics Pvt. Ltd. at Gurugram, Pune and Bengaluru, unless a section says otherwise

1. Purpose

This policy gives employees a fair way to raise work-related concerns, and sets out how the Company deals with misconduct. Complaints of sexual harassment follow HR-05, not this policy.

2. What is a Grievance

A grievance is a work-related concern, such as an unfair performance rating, unfair treatment by a manager or colleague, discrimination, pay or leave disputes, workplace conditions, or a wrongly applied policy.

3. Grievance Levels

Level	Who handles it	Target time to respond and resolve
Level 1	Reporting manager (or skip-level manager if the issue is with the manager)	5 working days
Level 2	HR Business Partner	7 working days
Level 3	Grievance Committee chaired by the Head of HR	15 working days

- Start at Level 1, unless the grievance is about your manager, in which case you can go directly to Level 2.
- Raise a grievance on the portal under "Raise a Concern" or by writing to hrhelpdesk@northbridge.example.
- If you are not satisfied with the response at one level, you can escalate to the next level within 10 working days.
- The decision of the Grievance Committee at Level 3 is final within the Company.

4. Confidentiality and Non-Retaliation

Grievances are handled confidentially and shared only with those who need to know. Retaliation against anyone who raises a grievance in good faith is gross misconduct. Concerns can also be raised anonymously through the ethics hotline (24x7) or ethics@northbridge.example.

5. Disciplinary Procedure

5.1 Types of misconduct

- **Minor misconduct:** repeated late arrival, minor dress code breach, careless use of Company resources, not following a reasonable instruction.
- **Major or gross misconduct:** fraud, theft, bribery, falsifying records or documents, harassment or violence, serious breach of data security or confidentiality, working under the influence of drugs or alcohol, unauthorised outside employment, abandonment of service, retaliation against a person who reported a concern.

5.2 Steps

Step	What happens
1. Informal counselling	For minor issues, the manager talks to the employee and notes it. This is not a disciplinary action.
2. Written warning	If it continues, HR issues a written warning stating the issue and the improvement expected.
3. Show-cause notice	For major misconduct, HR issues a notice with the allegation. The employee replies in writing within 3 working days.
4. Inquiry	A committee of at least 3 members, including HR and a senior not connected with the matter, hears the employee, examines evidence and gives findings, normally within 30 days.
5. Decision	The Head of HR and department head decide the action, informing the employee in writing with reasons.

5.3 Possible actions

- Written warning or final warning.
- Withholding of increment or promotion for one cycle.
- Recovery of any loss caused to the Company.
- Suspension during the inquiry (with a subsistence allowance of 50% of basic salary) or as a penalty.
- Termination of employment for gross misconduct, without notice pay, after the inquiry.

5.4 Appeal

An employee can appeal against a disciplinary decision to the Head of HR within 10 working days of receiving it. A decision on the appeal is given within 15 working days.

Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of change
3.0	1 January 2026	Annual review and update. Fictional policy created for demonstration of the HR helpdesk chatbot.